CULTIVATE

Iowa Homeschool Compliance Checklist

What to track to stay compliant · for your records · verified June 2026

Your requirements at a glance

Instruction required	148 days / year
Standardized testing	No standardized testing required
Legal citation	Iowa Code 299A

The rule, in plain English

Iowa: under the Competent Private Instruction (CPI) option, 148 days (at least 37 per quarter). The independent private-instruction (IPI) option has no day requirement. Most options have no testing.

Your records checklist

- ❑ File your state's required notice, affidavit, or registration — before the deadline.
- ❑ Keep a **daily log of instruction by subject** for each child.
- ❑ Track **days of instruction** toward 148/year and keep an attendance register.
- ❑ Save **work samples / a portfolio** for each child (a few per subject, per term).
- ❑ Keep a **curriculum & reading list** of what you taught.
- ❑ Keep any evaluations or progress notes you choose to do.
- ❑ Build a **high-school transcript** as you go (grades 9–12) so credits aren't reconstructed later.
- ❑ Store immunization or exemption records if your state requires them.
- ❑ Keep everything in **one place, backed up** — so a records request is a non-event.

Tired of tracking all this on paper?

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This is a plain-English summary for your convenience (verified June 2026), not legal advice. Cultivate helps you store, organize, and produce your homeschool records — it isn't the authority on what your state requires. Homeschool laws change; always confirm current rules with your state or a homeschool legal resource (e.g., HSLDA) before relying on them. Source citation shown above.